

The environmental impact of the AI revolution is starting to come into focus

Posted by u/NuseAI • • 0 points • 4 comments

- The environmental impact of the AI revolution is starting to become clear, with generative AI like ChatGPT increasing Google Search's energy use more than tenfold.
- The worry is that the computing power required for AI could lead to increased energy consumption and carbon footprint of data centers.
- AI already accounted for 10 to 15 percent of Google's electricity consumption in 2021.
- Google claims that the energy needed to power AI technology is increasing at a much slower rate than predicted, and they are implementing practices to reduce the carbon footprint of AI workloads.
- The worst-case scenario of Google Search using as much electricity as Ireland is unlikely, but the potential energy consumption of AI servers could grow significantly if AI's popularity continues to rise.

Source : <https://www.theverge.com/2023/10/10/23911059/ai-climate-impact-google-openai-chatgpt-energy>

Comments

u/tjdogger • 2 points • 2023-10-11 16:17 UTC

No worries, Google has pledge to be running solely on carbon free energy by 2030.

u/Aquaritek • 1 points • 2023-10-11 13:43 UTC

Big tech is aware of the energy usage of AI. Microsoft recelty announced their diving into Mini Nuclear Reactor research for exactly this reason.

Humanity has put the cart before the horse when it comes to progression forever. Consequences lead to change not predictive analysis or forecasting. Great example: Big oil has known about the climate change issue since the 50's and has made little to no effort in changing. Why can only be answered by "it doesn't hurt enough yet". Which exactly models human behavior.

Climate change is starting to hurt us now and people's appetite for bullshit around it is starting to wane. AI will drive newer more progressive forms of energy production because it is an energy hog but people want it and also don't want the pain of climate change.

We may have thought AI or AGI would solve the issue but it's likely we're going to solve the issue first to even get the damn thing running.

u/YinglingLight • 1 points • 2023-10-11 03:18 UTC

"AI" = the programmed masses. aka us.

"icebergs melting" = how conducive the environment is for spies

Reconcile Roko's Basilisk and the first "Global Warming" article being back in 1948! Timed to a certain Un-American Activities Committee.

Knowing this symbolism, it makes perfect sense that "AI would cause Climate Change". I, for one, am going to be pissed off if it **doesn't**.

u/htop_over_top • 1 points • 2023-10-10 18:56 UTC

Where do they talk about how AI is being used to improve efficiency? It seems one should measure the weight of both sides before claiming that the picture is coming into focus.

u/InnerOuterTrueSelf • 6 points • 2023-10-10 18:45 UTC

Solving the energy problem is a political and economical issue. Not a physics or engineering issue. If there ever was a time to do it, it's right now.